

KIT 2 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · RUN KIT 1 FIRST

Prompting Basics: Getting Useful Results Every Time

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready.

What this session is

Kit 1 made staff safe; this session makes them effective. Staff learn the four-part prompt formula (role, task, context, format), watch three live prompt makeovers, learn to iterate in three deliberate rounds instead of settling for the first draft, and spend the lab building **one reusable prompt template for a task they do every week**. That template goes into a shared staff prompt doc, which this session creates if it doesn't exist yet.

The quiet payoff: the 2025 Gallup survey found teachers who use AI weekly save nearly six hours a week, while four in ten teachers don't use AI at all. The distance between those groups is mostly the skill taught in this hour.

Who should present it

Same bar as Kit 1: any confident colleague. You do not need to be a prompt expert; the makeovers are fully scripted, the answers to likely questions are in boxes, and a live AI mistake during the lab is a teaching gift, not a failure.

One new prep item matters most: the shared staff prompt doc. Create an empty shared document (Google Doc, OneNote, whatever your school uses) titled "Our Prompt Library" before the session. The lab's final step has everyone paste their template into it. Walking out with a live, growing document is the session's proudest artifact.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
Welcome & the gap	0:00–0:05	The six-hours-a-week stat; why "just ask" fails
Anatomy of a prompt	0:05–0:12	The colleague test; role · task · context · format
Live makeovers	0:12–0:24	Three before/after rewrites + the spice rack + diagnosis drill
Iterate, don't settle	0:24–0:30	Three rounds: content, voice, details; iterate vs. start over
Lab: reusable prompt	0:30–0:49	Everyone builds, iterates, templates, and saves one prompt
Making it stick	0:49–0:54	One-slide summary; honest limits; commitment #4
First 48 hours & close	0:54–0:56	Action sheet + exit ticket

Core session is 56 minutes. For a 45-minute slot, run one iteration round in the lab and trim the share-out; the script marks the cuts.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Create the staff prompt doc** (3 min): empty shared doc, one title, link it somewhere staff already look. Have the link ready to project.
- ☐ **Skim the script once** (5 min): the three makeovers on slides 9–11 are the heart; read those aloud once so they land smoothly.
- ☐ **Click through the deck** (2 min): confirm all 30 slides display.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (3 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.
- ☐ **Send the one-line staff email** (2 min): "Bring a charged device and one task you do every week (newsletter, quiz, leveled reading). You'll leave with it automated."

Room, tech & timing

Same setup as Kit 1: projector, Wi-Fi, pair seating, a visible clock. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30. It is the session. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab. If Wi-Fi fails, run the lab on the projector with the room dictating prompts to you; the iteration rounds work surprisingly well as a whole-group sport.

Facilitator FAQ

"What if someone says this is just common sense?"

Agree cheerfully; that's the point. A good prompt is clear thinking written down. Then ask them to share their best prompt in the staff doc, because common sense that saves six hours a week deserves to be contagious.

"What if the AI gives a wrong or weird answer during a makeover?"

Point at it and celebrate: "That's the Kit 1 lesson proving itself; prompting improves quality, verification stays ours." Then iterate live. Watching you push back teaches more than any slide.

"What if staff want tool recommendations?"

Stay tool-agnostic: the formula works in every major chatbot. If your district has approved a specific tool, use that one in the lab and say so plainly.

"What if someone asks about students writing prompts?"

Park it visibly: student use is Kit 5 (academic integrity) and Kit 14 (teaching students about AI). Today is staff skill.

After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as PD documentation.
- Skim the "one prompt I still want help with" column; those become Prompt Autopsy material for the PLC follow-ups.
- Check the staff prompt doc has entries; nudge stragglers with one friendly line.

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